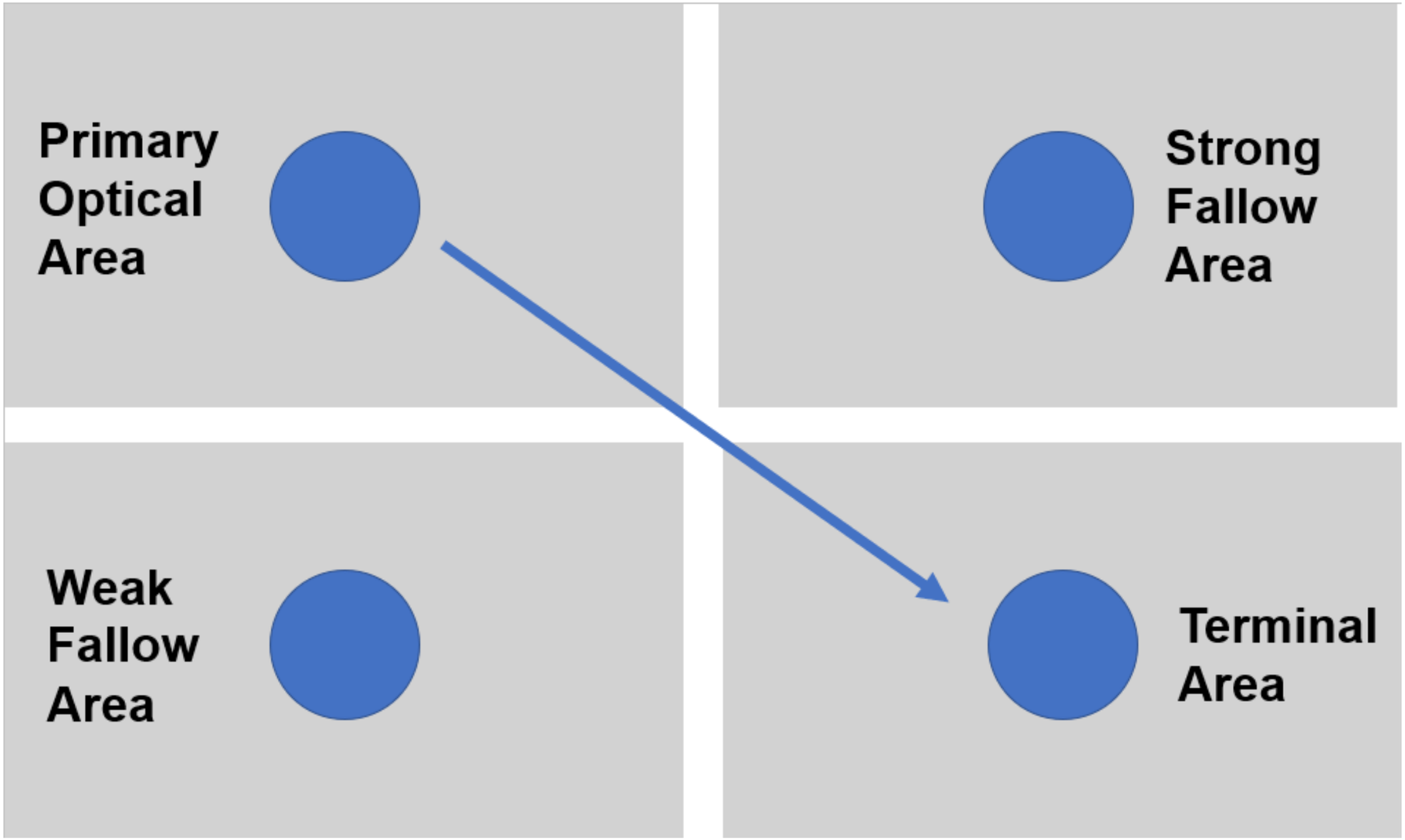
Tracking focal points

USER-ORIENTED DESIGN IN POWER BI

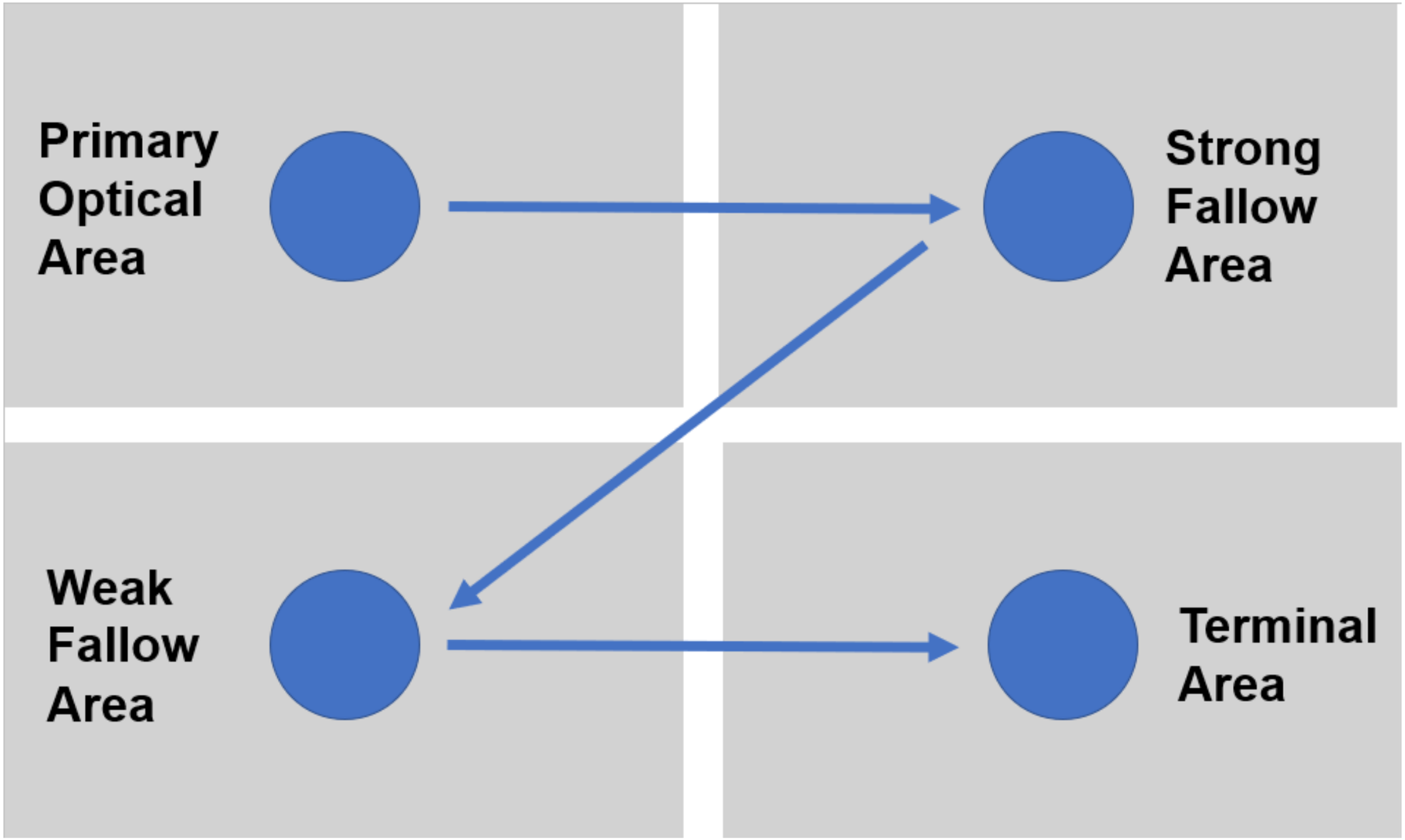
Maarten Van den Broeck
Content Developer at DataCamp

datacamp

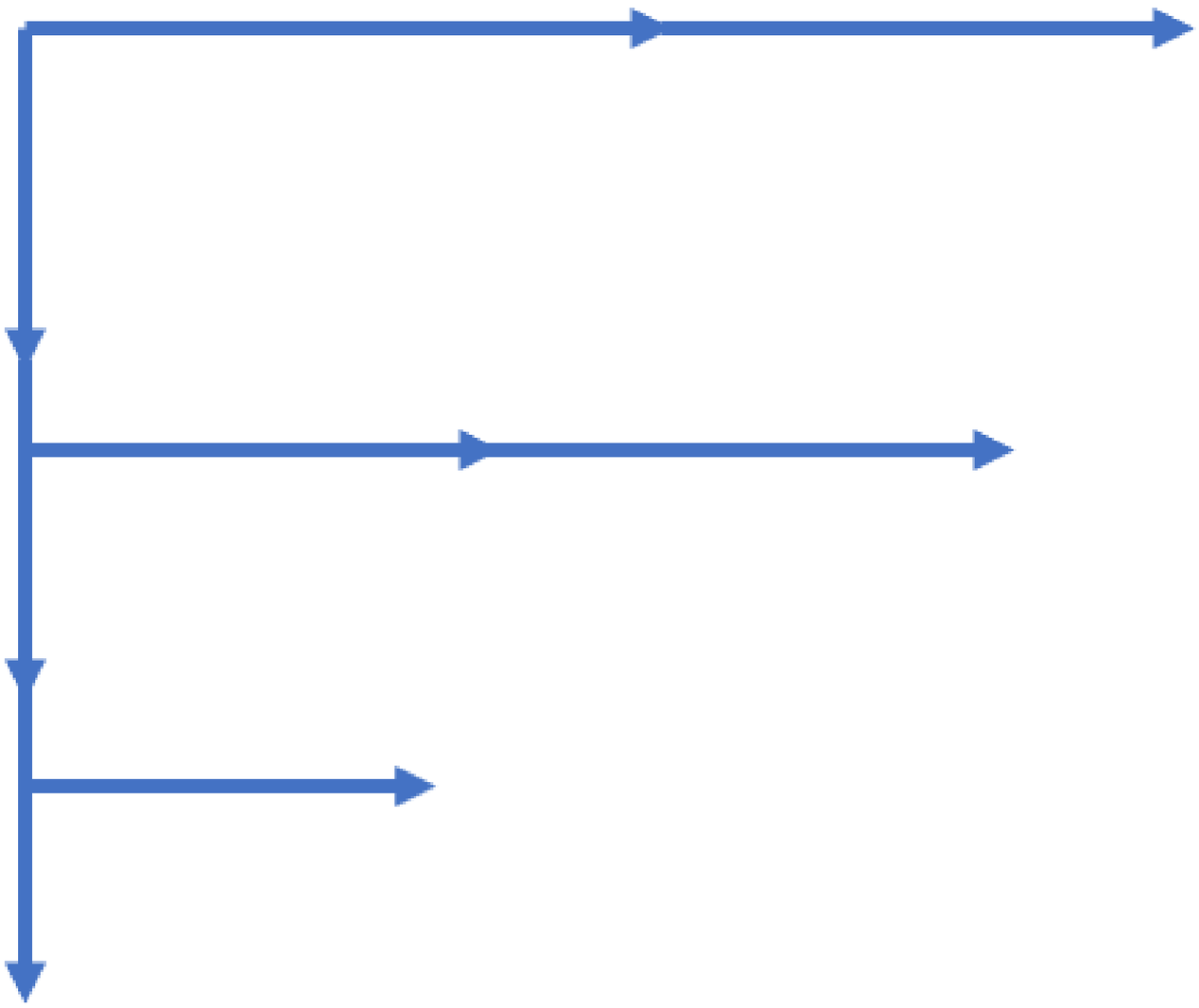
The Gutenberg layout



The Z layout

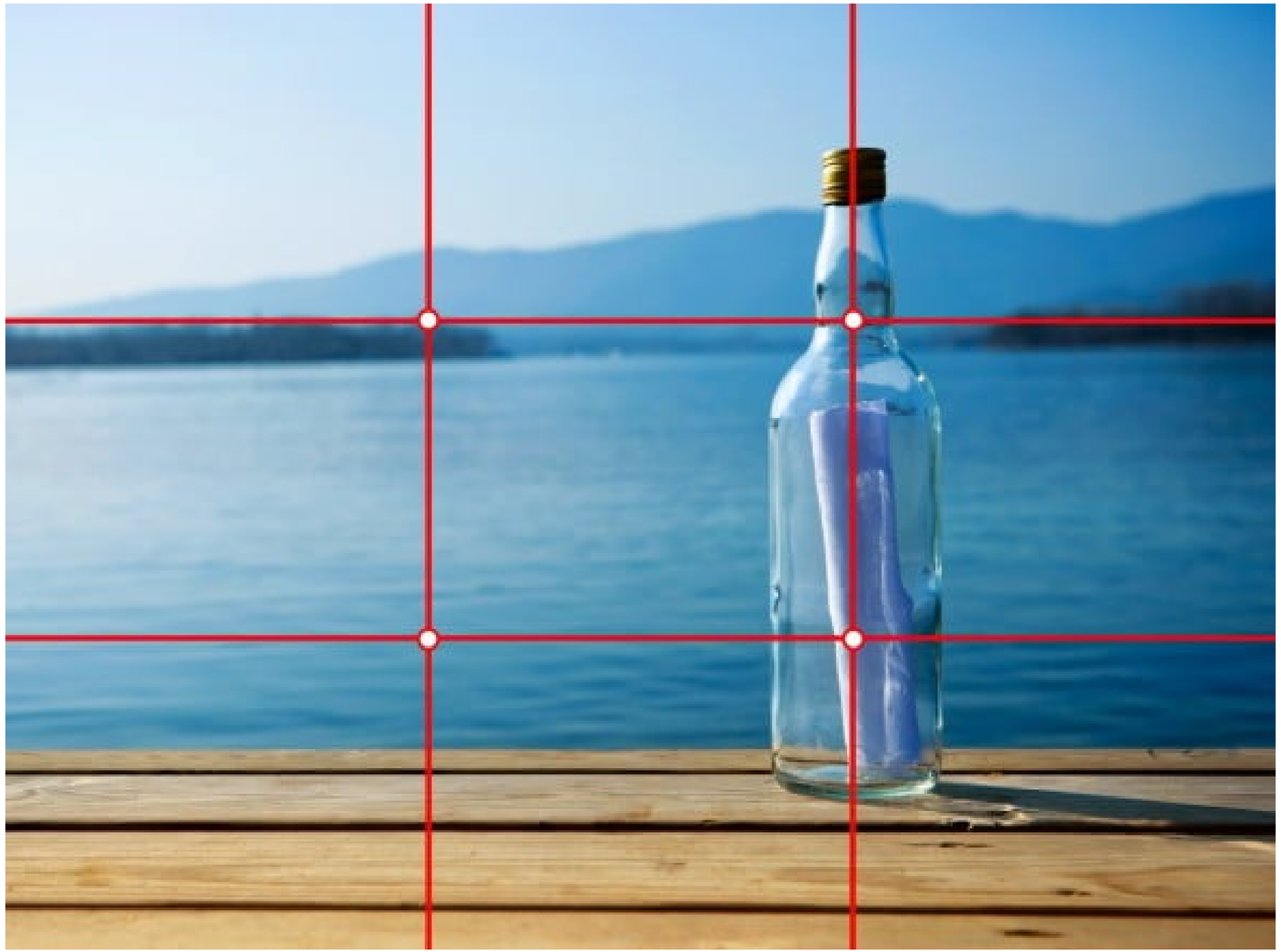

Primary Optical Area
Strong Fallow Area
Weak Fallow Area
Terminal Area

The F layout



Focal points

The rule of thirds



The dataset

- Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) Consumer Price Index (CPI) data
- 100 = baseline, with baselines being re-normed occasionally
- Ranges from 1913 to July 2021
- Broken out by item and geographic region

Our audience

- Research organization looking to understand inflation trends
- Has data in Power BI but not sure how to maximize its power

Let's practice!

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Designing for accessibility

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Color vision deficiency (CVD)

- Affects approximately 8% of men and 0.5% of women
- Two key causes: a deficiency of particular cones in the eye ("anomaly") or the absence of particular cones in the eye ("anopia")

[1] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Color_blindness

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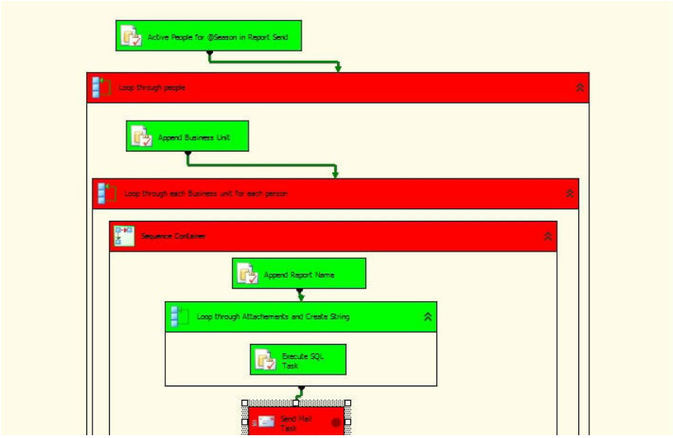
- Two key causes: a deficiency of particular cones in the eye ("anomaly") or the absence of particular cones in the eye ("anopia")

Name	Cones	Likelihood
Protanomaly	Red	1% Men
Protanopia	Red	1% Men
Deuteranomaly	Green	5% Men
Deuteranopia	Green	1% Men
Tritanomaly	Blue	Rare M/F
Tritanopia	Blue	Rare M/F

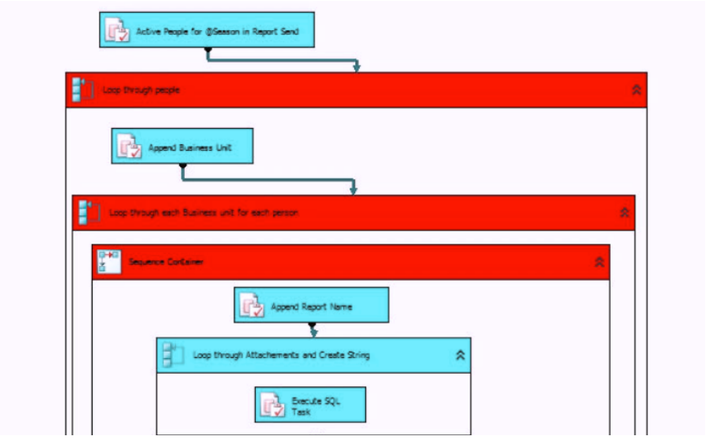
[1] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Color_blindness

CVD in action

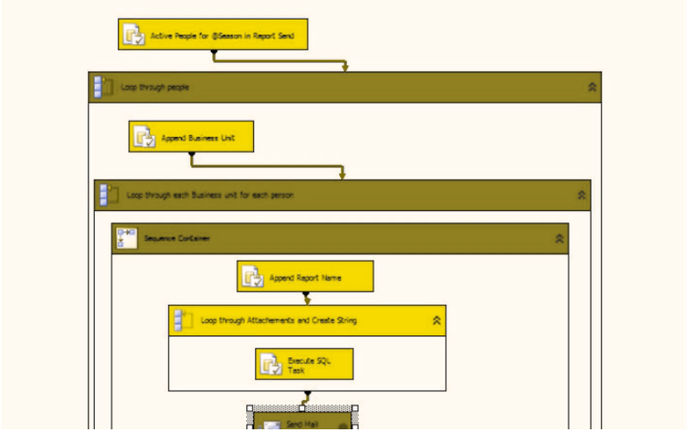
Typical vision



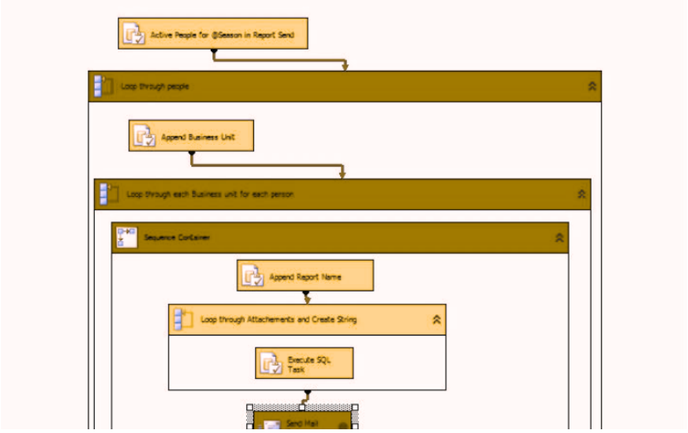
Tritanopia



Protanopia

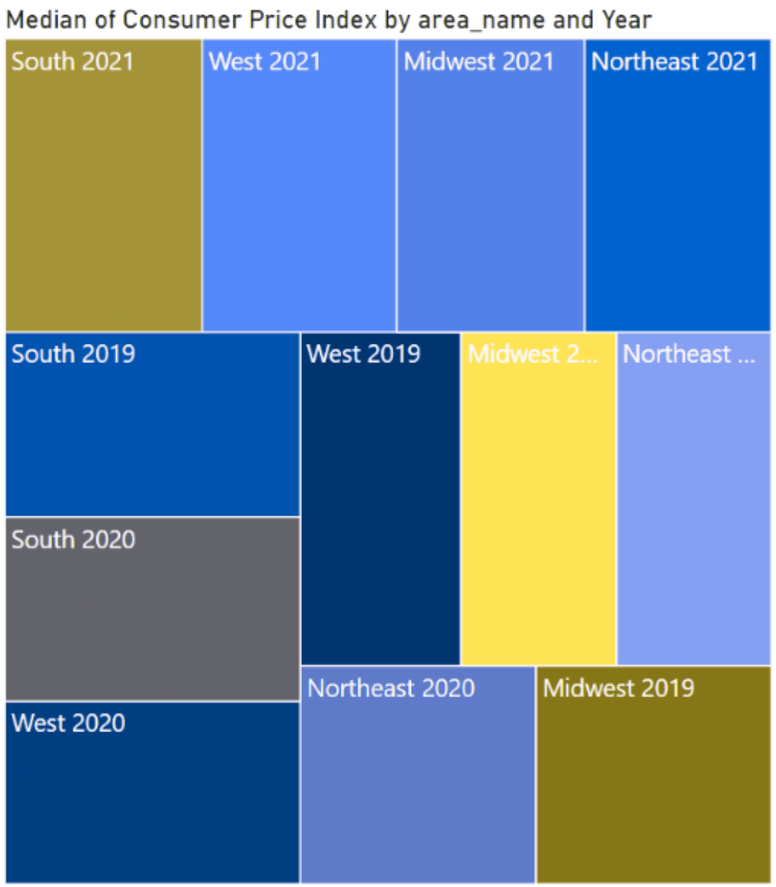


Deuteranopia

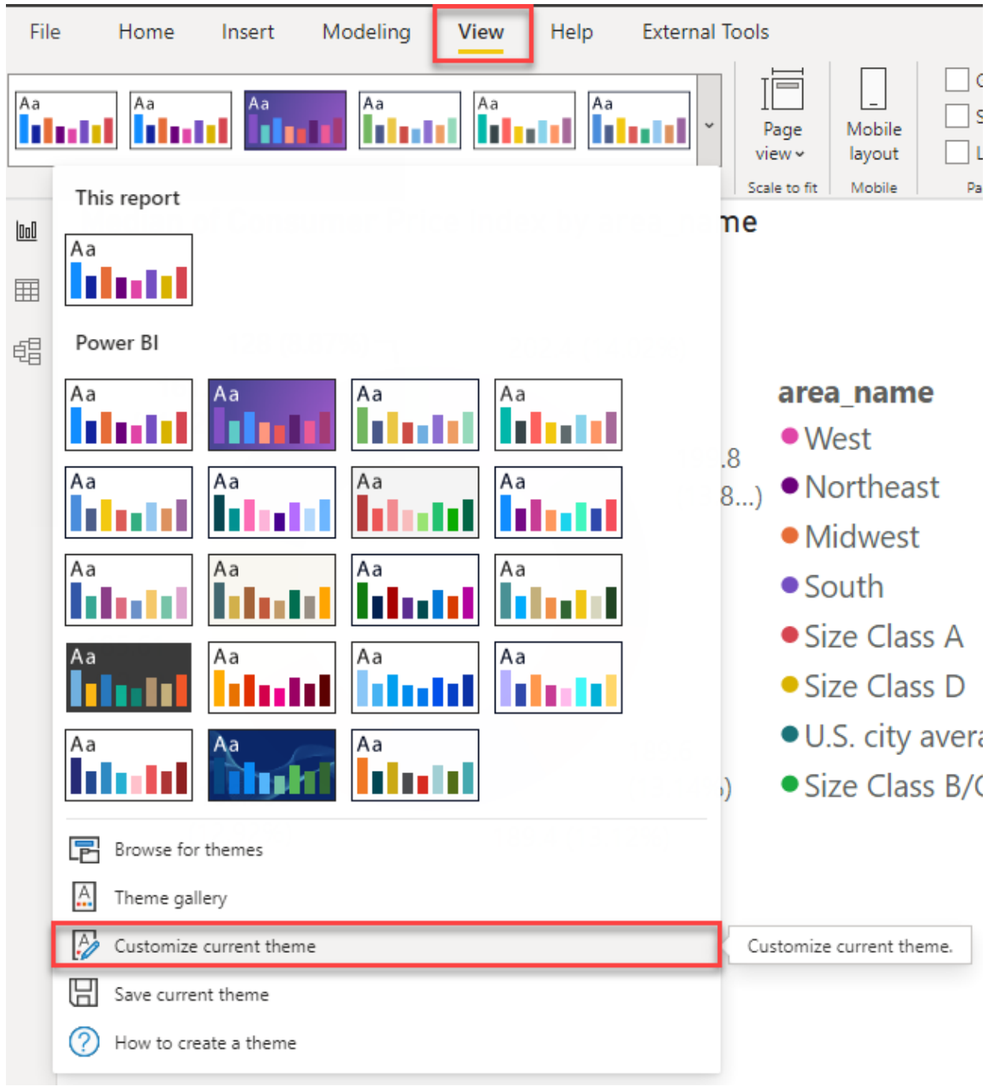


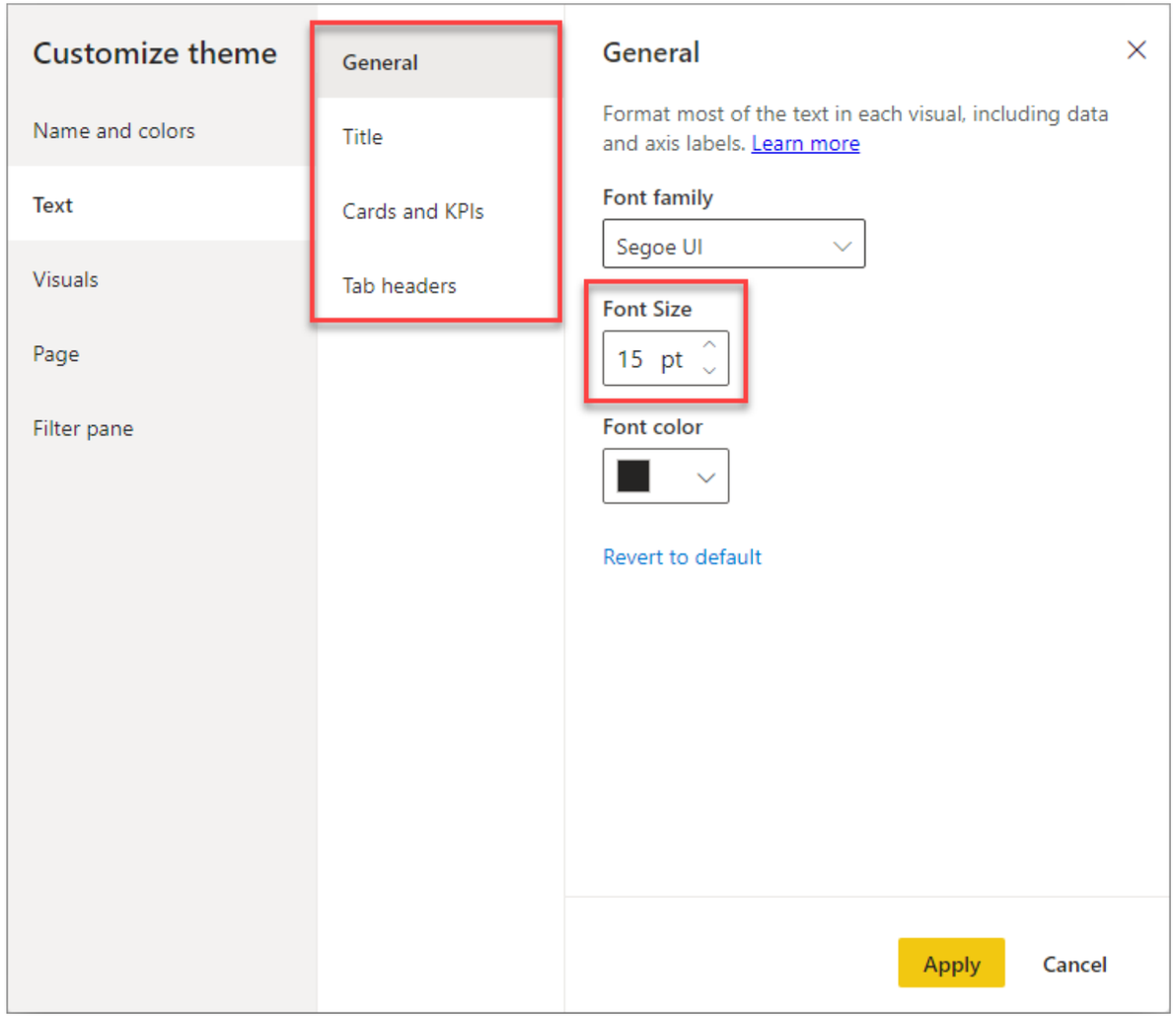
Tips for better color usage

- Less is more!
- Prefer visuals which do not need to use color as a signal
- Use CVD-friendly color palettes
- Have indicators other than color
- Use tools like Coblis

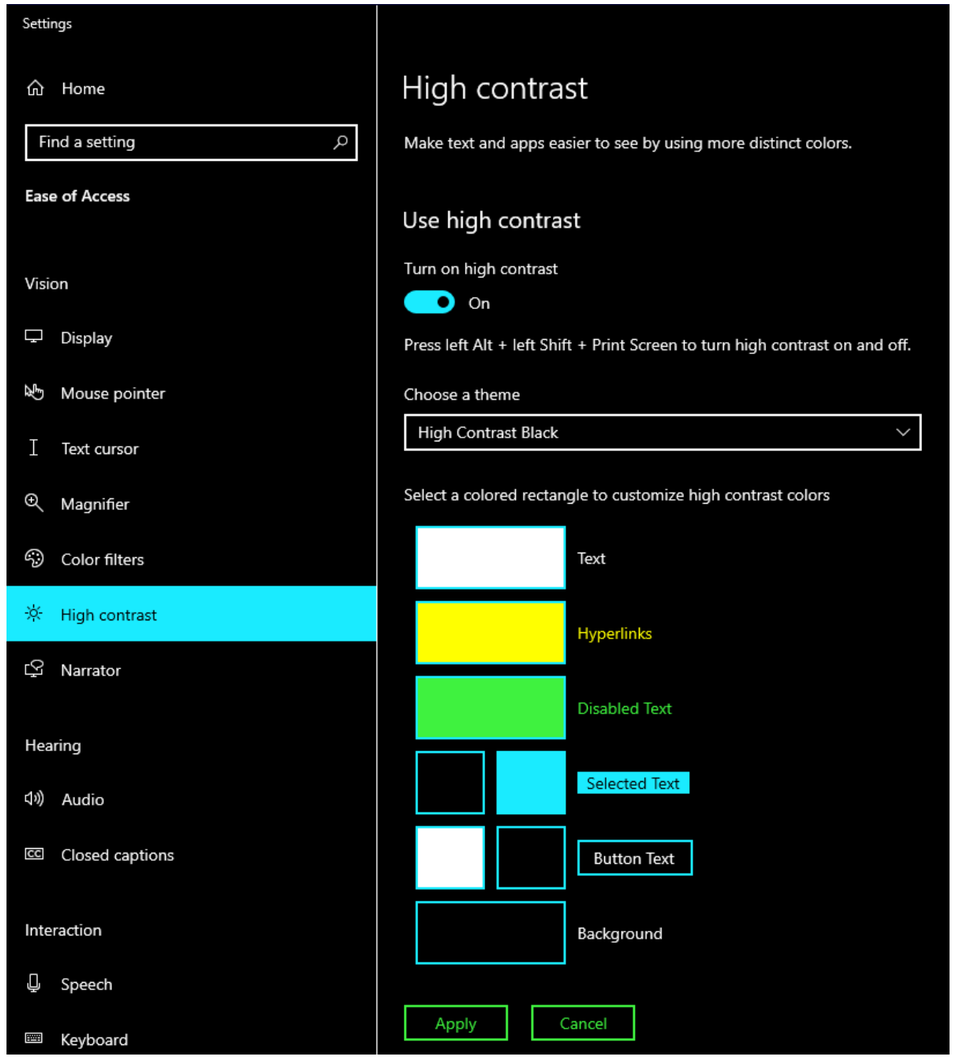


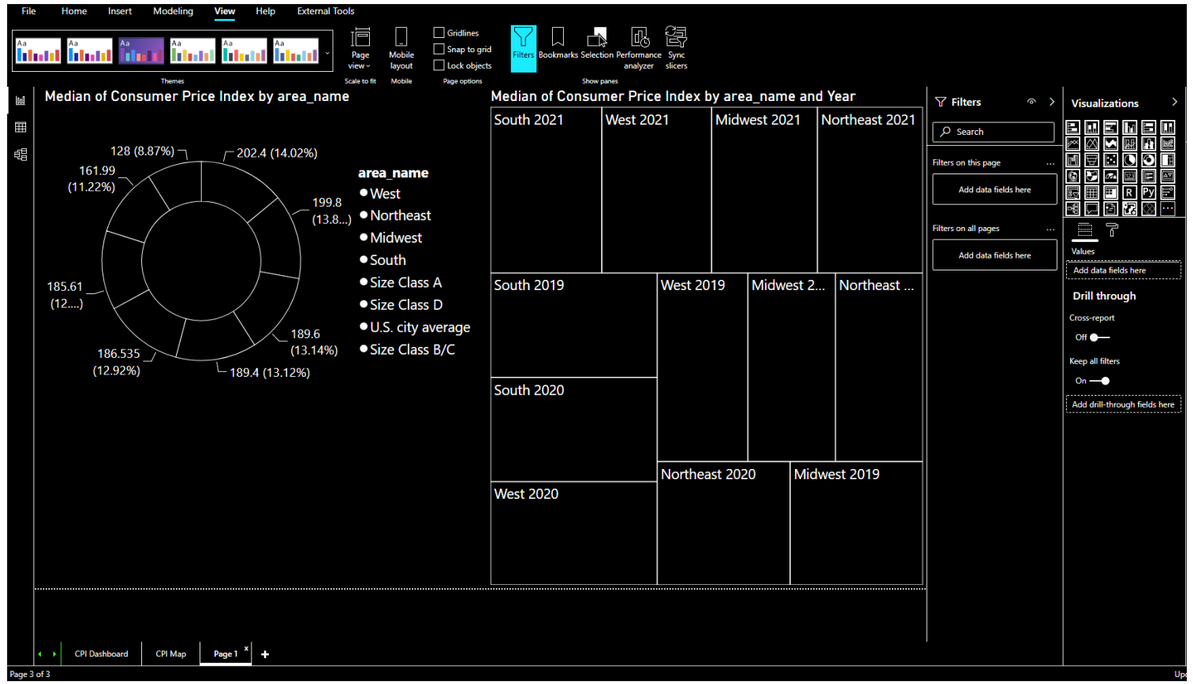
Font Sizes


File
Home
Insert
Modeling
View
Help
External Tools
Page view
Mobile layout
Scale to fit
Mobile
This report
Power BI
Browse for themes
Theme gallery
Customize current theme
Save current theme
How to create a theme
Customize current theme.
area_name
West
Northeast
Midwest
South
Size Class A
Size Class D


Customize theme
Name and colors
Text
Visuals
Page
Filter pane
General
Title
Cards and KPIs
Tab headers
General
Format most of the text in each visual, including data and axis labels. Learn more
Font family
Segoe UI
Font Size
15 pt
Font color
Revert to default
Apply
Cancel

High Contrast Mode



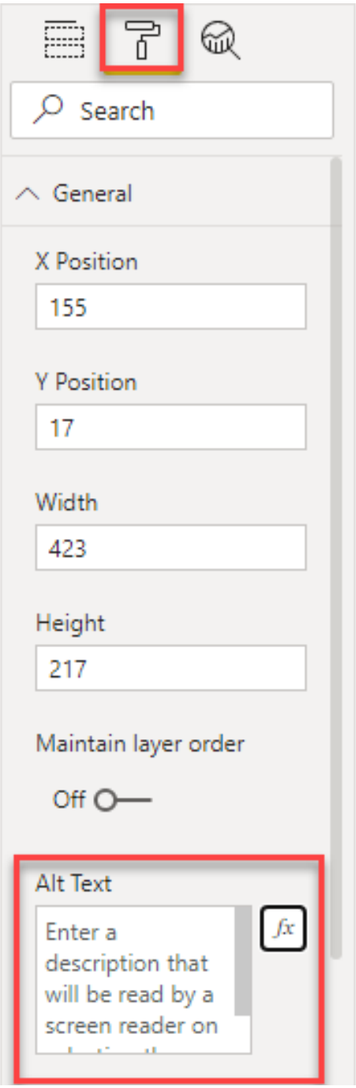


Increasing contrast

- Contrast ratio: difference in perceived brightness between two colors
- Recommended at least 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text (18 points or larger)
- Background images typically lead to lower contrast ratios
- Use contrast testing tools to check this

Screen readers

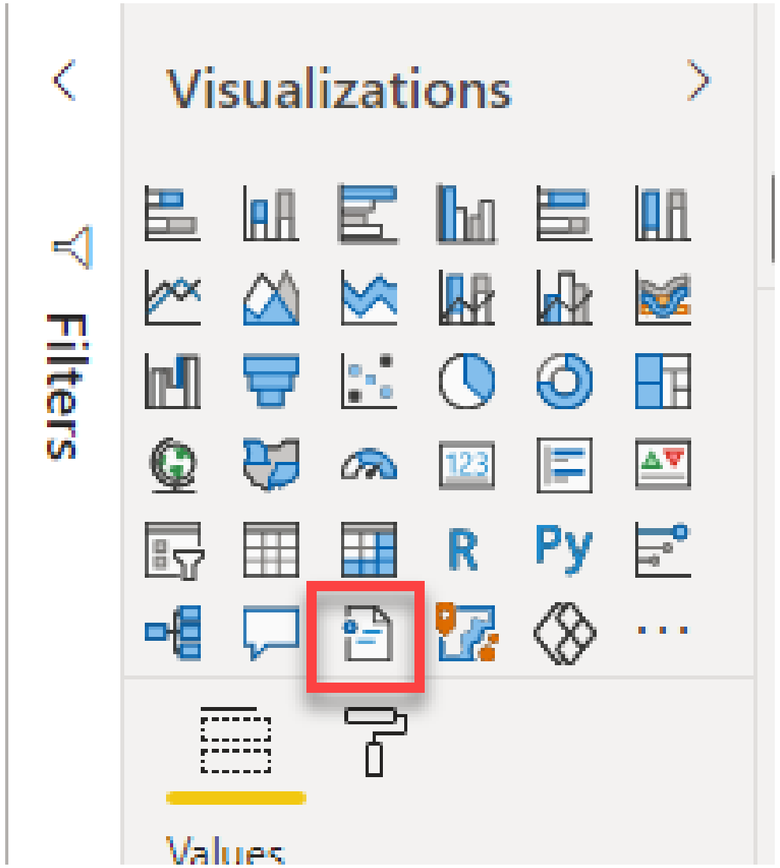
- Power BI supports screen readers--tools which speak aloud the text on a page or the "alt text" of an image for users with limited vision
- Power BI supports showing a visual as a table, making it easier for a reader to list values
- Alt Text describes the visual and can be based on static text or the value of a field
- Keyboard shortcuts are limiting and screen readers don't read all contents.



Smart narratives

At 0.34, Tim Anderson, CHW had the highest AVG and was 60.85% higher than Richie Martin, BAL, which had the lowest AVG at 0.21.

Across all 36 nameAndTeam, AVG ranged from 0.21 to 0.34.



Our audience

- Research organization looking to understand inflation trends
- Report users may have visual accessibility concerns

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Accessibility in practice

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